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HSBC/UM MACAU BUSINESS CASE COMPETITION 2026

Daydreamer University of Macau



Round 1

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

THE CORE ARGUMENT:

REG must transform from an event promoter to Greater China's K-Culture ecosystem builder to counteract market diversion and unlock new growth.



⚠️ 1. Structural Challenges

MARKET DIVERSION

- Potential Mainland opening threatens the **60-70% core audience**.
- HK risks losing exclusivity as fans **bypass the city** for local tours.

CULTURAL DISCONNECT

- Current K-pop and local idol tie-ups are **highly superficial**.
- REG misses out on massive **C-Pop monetization** and long-term IP.

INDUSTRY STAGNATION

- K-pop album export growth has plummeted to **0.55%**.
- Profitability is squeezed by **over-reliance on hardcore fans**.

🎪 2. Strategic Solutions

PREMIUM FESTIVAL HUB

- Leverage the new for exclusive Asian premieres. **Kai Tak Stadium (50K cap)**
- Host multi-day mega-events (MAMA, KCON) forming an **irreplicable barrier**

THE REVERSE INCUBATOR

- Utilize CJ ENM to pioneer **C-Pop x K-Pop idol collaborations**.
- Transition REG from a distributor to an **IP content co-owner**.

DATA-DRIVEN ECOSYSTEM

- Deploy for dynamic pricing & risk mitigation. **Business Intelligence (BI)**
- Systematically convert into paying attendees. **casual listeners**

🎯 3. Target Goals (2028)

-30%

TICKET RELIANCE

Reduce dependency on volatile, **low-margin** single-event ticket sales.

40%

HIGH-MARGIN REVENUE

Boost share of **sponsorships** and **IP licensing** across the ecosystem.

>60%

MAINLAND RETENTION

Secure high-net-worth fans through **exclusive mega-festivals** despite market opening.

INDUSTRY ANALYSIS

Competitive landscape, revenue models & REG's structural gap



COMPETITIVE LANDSCAPE

Live Nation US / Global

- ✓ World's largest live entertainment co.
- ✓ JYP global exclusive deal (2023)
- ✗ No Chinese entertainment DNA
- ✗ Cannot bridge Korean-Chinese content

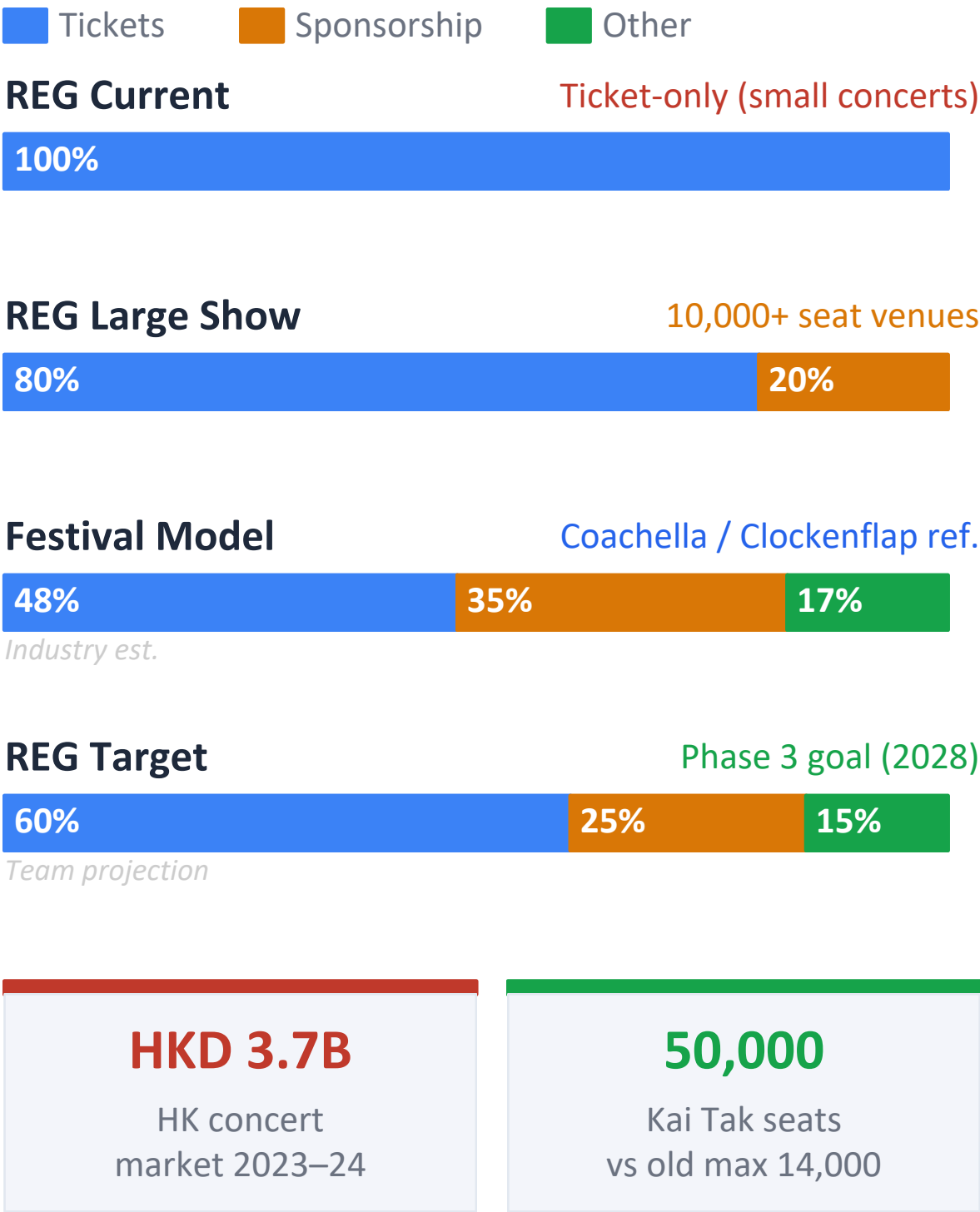
iMe Entertainment Mainland China

- ✓ Chinese capital — outbids rivals on guarantees
- ✓ **Strong Mainland China distribution channels**
- ✗ Zero Korean IP production capability
- ✗ K-pop concerts still restricted in Mainland China

K-pop Industry Risks Structural headwinds

- ⚠ "Seven-Year Curse": disbandments at contract expiry
- ⚠ Korean Military service interrupts male idol activities
- ✗ Album sales fell 19% in 2024 (first drop in 10 yrs)
- ✗ J-pop precedent: 50% sales drop in 15 years

REVENUE MODEL ANALYSIS



REG'S STRUCTURAL EDGE

Capability	Live Nation	iMe	REG
Korean IP Production	✓	✗	✓
Greater China Channels	✗	✓	✓
HK Neutral Platform	✗	✗	✓
K-pop Ecosystem Depth	✗	✗	✓
Content Creation Rights	✓	✗	✓

THE COMPETITIVE WHITE SPACE

REG is the **only player** with Korean IP + Greater China access + HK neutral platform. Neither Live Nation nor iMe can replicate this trifecta.

K-pop Album Export Growth

82.6% → **0.55%**

YoY growth: 2019–20 → 2023–24

Company & Industry Analysis

REG today — and why the status quo cannot hold



REG TODAY

WHO WE ARE

CJ ENM subsidiary · HK-based concert promoter
Operating in: Hong Kong · Macau · Taipei

REVENUE MODEL

Small concert: ~100% ticket sales
Large (10K+ seats): up to 20% sponsorship

KEY IP ASSETS

- **MAMA AWARDS** (world's #1 K-pop ceremony)
- **KCON** (world's largest K-culture festival)

HKD 3.7B

HK concert
market 2023–24

60–70%

Mainland fans
at HK K-pop

83%

Mainland visitors
at KCON HK

TRIGGERS FOR CHANGE

Market Threat

1

Mainland may open → HK's monopoly
window at risk

Competition Rising

2

Live Nation: JYP global exclusive
iMe: Chinese capital, higher artist
guarantees

K-pop Growth Stalling

3

Album export growth:

82.6%

→

0.55%

2019–20 vs 2023–24

New Infrastructure

4

Kai Tak Stadium opened 2025
50,000 seats — HK's first world-class venue

THE CORE TENSION

REG HAS

The greatest K-pop cultural IPs
in Greater China
→ MAMA AWARDS + KCON



REG DOES

Passive concert promoter
→ Earning ticket margins only



THE RISK

Once mainland opens —
mainland fans go to Beijing & Shanghai
directly.
Live Nation & iMe take the rest.

MARKET ANALYSIS

Evolving audience demands and government tailwinds — why the window for REG is opening now



EXISTING AUDIENCE

Gen 2–3 | Millennial

60-70%

Mainland China visitors

HKD800–2,000

ticket price range

81%

female audience

Mainland Pilgrims

Travel to HK specifically for K-pop. Seek full weekend experience: concert + dining + shopping. Use Weibo & Damai for ticketing.

Local Loyalists

Students & young women aged 15–24. Deep fandom, strong social media engagement. Price-sensitive but highly loyal.

WHY THEY MATTER TO REG

83% of KCON HK overseas visitors were from Mainland China — the highest-value, most travel-ready audience REG already has.

Existing hardcore fans: high ARPU, travel-ready, platform-native (Weibo/Damai)

EMERGING AUDIENCE

Gen Z | K-culture Fan

The new majority — currently underserved

HOW THEY DISCOVER K-POP

Xiaohongshu (RED)

Lifestyle content & idol aesthetics

TikTok / Douyin

Short-form dance & challenge trends

Instagram Reels

Concert highlights, fan-made content



WHAT THEY WANT (vs old audience)

Before

Albums + concerts only

Now → K-culture lifestyle: food, beauty, fashion + music

Before

Hardcore fan identity

Now → Casual entry — KCON day passes, livestreams

Before

Travel to Seoul / Tokyo

Now → Accessible HK events with social media moments

Emerging Gen Z fans: K-culture lifestyle seekers, driven by Xiaohongshu/TikTok

HK GOVERNMENT SUPPORT

Policy 1

Concert Economy Initiative

▶ HKSAR declared concert economy a policy priority (Jan 2025)

▶ HKD 3.7B market → HKD 2.2B GDP contribution

▶ Tourism Board packages K-pop tourism for Mainland China visitors

HKSAR Gov. Press Release, Jan 2025

Policy 2

Kai Tak Sports Park

▶ HKD 32B government infrastructure investment

▶ 50,000-seat stadium with retractable roof & acoustics

▶ Resolves 10-year venue gap that cost HK major events

Kai Tak Sports Park, 2025

Policy 3

Tourism Board MOU

▶ MOUs signed with promoters for K-pop tourism packages

▶ Hotel + ticket + fan bundles on Damai & Mainland China platforms

▶ Weibo & Damai promotional channels officially backed

HKTB Partnership Programme

Government & infrastructure: HK is now the best-equipped city to capture both

REG CUSTOMERS

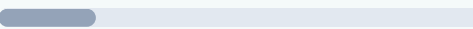
To maximize monetization and defend against market diversion, REG must deploy tailored strategies across three distinct customer profiles.



Mainland Core Fans

60 – 70% OF AUDIENCE

Willingness to Pay 

Price Sensitivity 

PROFILE & BEHAVIOR

- Highly active on for ticketing and fan updates.
Weibo and Damai
- Willing to incur (flights, hotels) to attend shows.
high cross-border travel costs

Strategic Need: They seek a complete weekend tourism and consumption experience, not just a 2-hour concert.



Local Loyalists

~ 15 – 20% OF AUDIENCE

Willingness to Pay 

Price Sensitivity 

PROFILE & BEHAVIOR

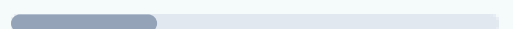
- Primarily residing in Hong Kong.
students and young females
- Exhibit to specific idol groups and core fandom culture.
extreme loyalty

Strategic Need: They demand authentic connection, community engagement, and exclusive local merchandise.



Casual Listeners

~ 10 – 25% OF AUDIENCE

Willingness to Pay 

Price Sensitivity 

PROFILE & BEHAVIOR

- Spillover from the core K-pop audience; interested in broader . **K-Culture lifestyle**
- Highly susceptible to and easily priced out of premium concerts. **pricing barriers**

Strategic Need: Require lower-barrier interactive products (e.g., KCON daytime passes) to enter the monetization funnel.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Three structural challenges REG must solve — before competitors do



Q1 — HK DIFFERENTIATION RISK

60–70%

of HK K-pop audiences are Mainland China visitors

THE THREAT CHAIN

Mainland market opens

Fans go direct to Beijing / Shanghai

HK loses 60–70% of its audience

EVIDENCE

- Taylor Swift Asia tour bypassed HK for larger venues
- HK lost bids to Singapore, Tokyo & Seoul for years
- Kai Tak (2025) fixes supply — differentiation still open

CORE QUESTION 1:

How does HK become irreplaceable — not just a convenient stopover?

Q2 — SINO-KOREAN COLLAB GAP

11

HK/Macau collabs
2016–2025

2

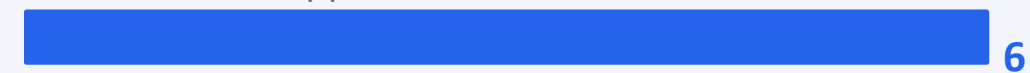
Mainland cases
(restrictions)

85%

HK/Macau share
of all collabs

Documented Collab Types (2016–2025)

Concert Guest Appearances



Group Member Collabs



Agency / Content Deals



PROVEN PRECEDENTS

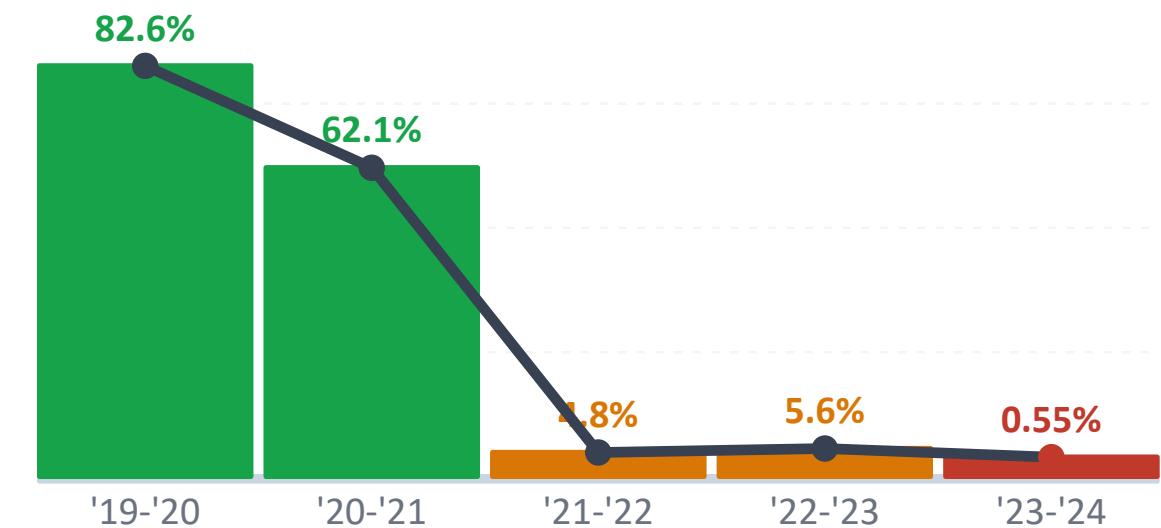
- ✓ EXO-M / SJ-M: CN sub-unit model proved demand
- ✓ (G)I-DLE: Mixed CN/TW/KR group (4th gen)

CORE QUESTION 2 :

How can REG build a systematic bridge between Korean & Chinese idol markets?

Q3 — K-POP GROWTH STAGNATION

K-pop Album Export YoY Growth (%)



⚠️ BTS / BLACKPINK Over-Reliance

New 4th-gen groups cannot replicate their commercial scale. HYBE chairman warned of industry crisis (2023).

⚠️ J-pop Precedent Warning

J-pop fell 50% in 15 years. Pop markets are not permanent — K-pop must expand its audience now.

CORE QUESTION 3:

How can REG expand K-pop's reach beyond hardcore fans?

STRATEGY OVERVIEW

Three problems → three targeted solutions — and a flywheel that makes them stronger together



PROBLEMS

Q1

HK Differentiation Risk

60–70% of audience are Mainland China visitors

If unsolved → risk

Q2

Sino-Korean Collab Gap

85% of collabs concentrated in HK / Macau

If unsolved → risk

Q3

K-pop Growth Stagnation

Export growth collapsed: 82.6% → 0.55%

If unsolved → risk

SOLUTIONS

S1

Premium Festival Hub

MAMA AWARDS + KCON + Kai Tak

- ▶ Lock in MAMA AWARDS permanently @ Kai Tak
- ▶ Pitch Asia-first debut for world tours
- ▶ Host KCON flagship festival at Kai Tak

S2

Reverse Incubator

CJ ENM Korean-Chinese Idol Bridge

- ▶ Joint KR-CN idol selection & debut program
- ▶ Bridge Artist initiative with HK/TW/CN idols
- ▶ Co-produced albums distributed via HK base

S3

Data-Driven Ecosystem

KCON Expansion + BI Intelligence

- ▶ KCON data pipeline to convert casual fans
- ▶ Build data warehouse & AI demand forecasting
- ▶ Identify casual fans → convert to concert buyers

SYNERGIES

FLYWHEEL EFFECT

S1

Festival Hub

Drives footfall
→ scales KCON audience

S2

Idol Bridge

Creates exclusive IP
→ differentiates REG

S3

Data Engine

Reduces investment risk
→ grows casual fans

↻

Cycle repeats

REG becomes
structurally indispensable

Each solution directly addresses one problem — and all three reinforce each other, creating a moat no single rival can replicate.

STRATEGY 1—— PREMIUM FESTIVAL HUB



Issues addressed:

If the Mainland China market were to open up, how would we compete with Beijing and Shanghai?

1 HK DIFFERENTIATION RISK



Establishing Hong Kong as a "Premium Festival Hub" via Kai Tak neutralizes Mainland China diversion through irreplicable, immersive weekend K-Culture ecosystems.

STRATEGIC FOCUS: KAI TAK SPORTS PARK & MAMA ECOSYSTEM



1. PERMANENT MAMA ANCHOR

- Kai Tak Sports Park(50K capacity) to compete directly with Los Angeles and Osaka. (**Anchor MAMA 2025**)
- In 2025, MAMA return to Hong Kong, taking advantage of the situation to establish it as an **annual flagship event**
- Amplifies HK's **cultural soft power** through global media and high-value brand endorsements.



2. EXCLUSIVE ASIAN PREMIERE

- Proactively secure Kai Tak as the mandatory **Asian premiere destination** for global world tours.
- Support the **super performance** form of multi-group mix-and-match and cross-border linkage
- I-DLE 2024 Hong Kong sold out plus the third show: **demand always exists, and supply used to be limited**



3. INTEGRATED CONSUMPTION

- Content expansion : fuse music with K-food, beauty, fashion, and gaming. (**KCON model**)
- Partner with Tourism Board for **"Hotel + Ticket + Experience"** packages on Mainland platforms.
- Relying on CJ ENM's experience in hosting KCON, the world's largest K-pop music festival, we have established an **exclusive flagship version** in Hong Kong

WHY MAINLAND CITIES CANNOT REPLICATE THIS MODEL

Regulatory Immunity

The "Hallyu ban" persists. Strict Mainland China approvals prohibit complex, multi-group crossover mega-festivals, whereas HK offers zero political risk.

Diversified Profitability

HK's commercial maturity allows up to 20% sponsorship ratios in large venues. Ticketing + sponsorships + merch ensures highly controllable cost-benefit ratios.

Unshakeable Brand Moat

HK's neutral international status solidifies its "Premiere City" brand. Once established, it requires years to be displaced by emerging Mainland China competitors.

STRATEGY 2—— The REVERSE INCUBATOR



Issues addressed:

As a Korean company based in Hong Kong, how to promote cross-border cooperation between Chinese and Korean idols?

2 CROSS-CULTURAL DISCONNECT

REG as Reverse Incubator: build proprietary KR-CN IP to solve the cross-cultural disconnect.

1. CJ ENM Joint Selection Program



- Leverage CJ ENM's established production pedigree (e.g., *Produce 101*).
 - Utilize **HK/Macau** as **neutral bases** to bypass Mainland regulatory hurdles.
 - Jointly launched the Korean-Chinese idol selection plan with Chinese entertainment companies
- Success example: EXO-M and SJ-M.*

2. Bridge Artist Program



- Institutionalize a structured cross-cultural performance system.
- Integrate top-tier HK/Chinese artists as regular guests on K-pop tours.
- Generate viral content moments providing Chinese stars K-pop stage exposure.

3. Co-Production Creative Camp



- Implement SM-style creative camps for intensive musical co-production.
- Fuse elite Korean production expertise with exceptional Chinese artistic talent.
- Develop co-owned IP created in HK and **distributed globally**.

THE REG MOAT: UNMATCHED STRATEGIC ADVANTAGE

Competitor Weaknesses	The REG Nexus (Key Differentiators)
No Chinese entertainment network or local operational roots.	1. Korean Content DNA: Exclusive access to CJ ENM's elite production resources and global artist networks.
	2. Chinese Market Channels: Established pathways and deep understanding of Mainland audience consumption habits.

STRATEGY 3—— DATA-DRIVEN ECOSYSTEM



Issues addressed:

How to deal with the slowdown in the growth of K-pop and maintain its vitality?

3 INDUSTRY STAGNATION



Deploying a Data-Driven BI Ecosystem and mass-market KCON expansion counters K-pop stagnation by mitigating investment risks and broadening the audience funnel.

PILLAR A: KCON MASS-MARKET EXPANSION



🏠 Strategic Repositioning

Evolve from a niche "fandom meetup" into a comprehensive "K-Culture Lifestyle Festival" integrating K-Food, Beauty, Fashion, and Gaming.

🎯 Targeting the "Casual Listener"

Capture the 18-30 female demographic across HK and Mainland who follow Korean trends but avoid expensive, hardcore K-pop concert tickets.

🛒 FMCG Sponsorship Upsell

Transition from traditional finance sponsors to Beauty/Food brands (e.g., COSRX, Bibigo). Goal: Increase sponsorship revenue share to 30-35%.

🏠 PILLAR B: DATA-DRIVEN BI OPERATIONS



🗄️ ETL & Data Warehousing

Integrate unstructured, multi-platform data (Damai, Weibo, Instagram, historical ticketing) into a centralized, actionable Data Mart.

🧠 AI Predictive Modeling

Utilize sentiment analysis to forecast real demand, providing quantitative leverage against inflated Artist Guarantee negotiations driven by competitors.

🔒 Embedded Compliance Architecture

Implement rigorous regulatory checkpoints within the ETL pipeline to ensure cross-border data transfer complies with HK and Mainland laws.

STRATEGIC IMPACT & SOLUTION VALIDATION

Three solutions compound each other – and together close every problem this case presents



S1

Premium Festival Hub

HK as Asia's K-pop Destination

50,000

Kai Tak seats vs 14,000 max before

MAMA 2025

Confirmed return to HK

► Drives Mainland China fan footfall to HK

► Creates Asia premiere brand prestige

► Anchors KCON scale expansion (S3)

S2

Reverse Incubator

CJ ENM Korean-Chinese Idol Bridge

1 IP

KR-CN collab project in 18 months

85%

Collabs currently HK/Macau-based

► Exclusive content differentiates REG events

► Earns royalties even if fans stay in Mainland China

► Cements CJ ENM's cross-cultural IP moat

S3

Data-Driven Ecosystem

KCON Mass Expansion + BI Engine

7K→15K

KCON attendance Phase 1→2

-30%

Reduction in ticket dependency

► Converts casual fans into concert buyers

► Lowers artist guarantee risk via data

► Builds sponsorship revenue to 25%+ share

COMPOUND SYNERGY — 3 Solutions > Sum of Parts

S1

drives footfall

→

S3

► scales KCON audience

S2

creates exclusive content

→

S1

► supports S1 premium pricing

S3

grows casual fan base

→

S1

► lowers artist guarantee pressure

S1

provides large-scale stage

→

S2

► content assets for IP co-creation

OVERALL REG IMPACT

Short-term

HK becomes Asia's most prestigious K-pop destination — surpassing Singapore & Tokyo

Mid-term

REG holds the only institutional infrastructure for KR-CN cultural collaboration

Long-term

REG is structurally indispensable — not just a promoter, but the K-pop cultural hub of Greater China

LOCK VERIFICATION — Every Problem Has an Answer

Q1

→

S1

✓ HK Premium Festival Hub → irreplaceable premiere destination

Q2

→

S2

✓ Reverse Incubator → systematic KR-CN collaboration bridge

Q3

→

S3

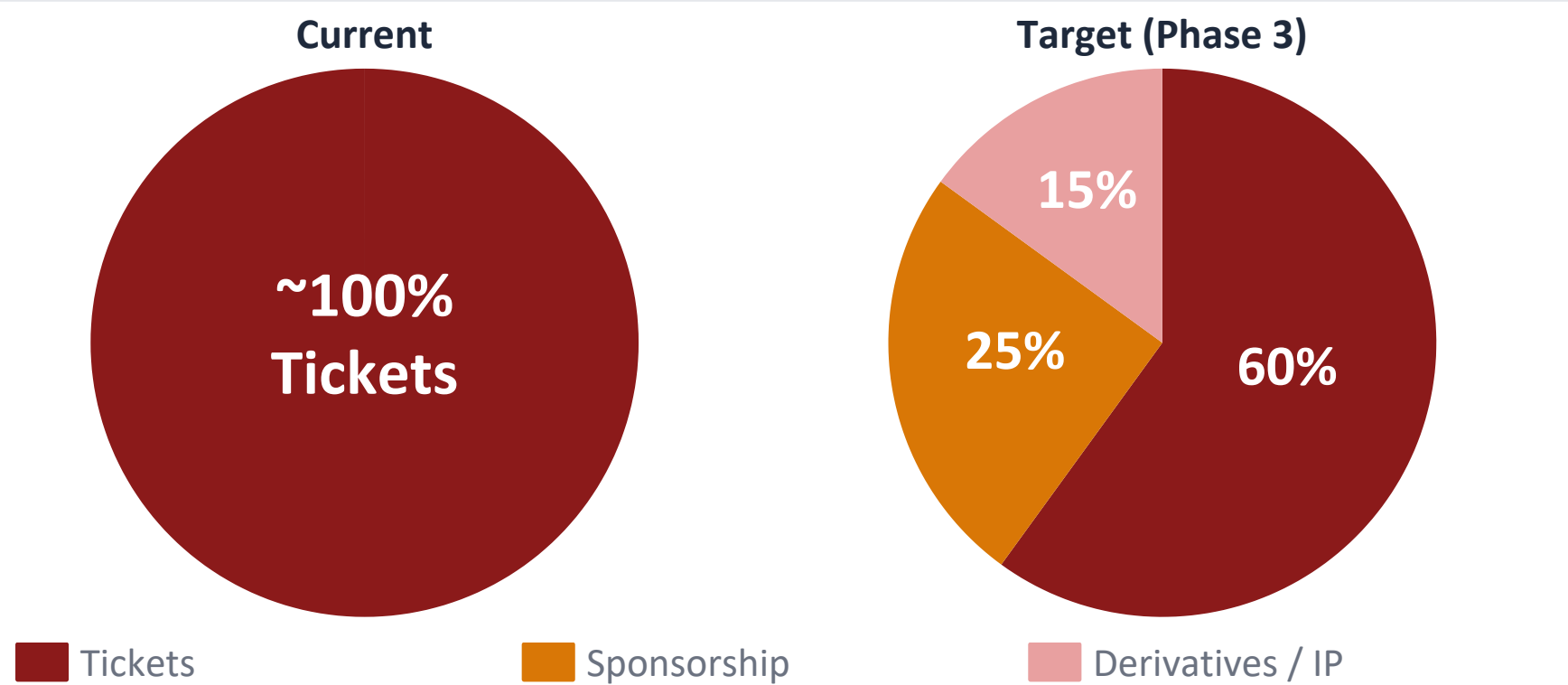
✓ Data Ecosystem + KCON → expanded audience & sustained growth

FINANCIAL FORECAST & BUSINESS MODEL

From single-revenue dependency to a diversified, resilient income structure by 2028



1 Revenue Restructuring



Revenue Source	Current		Target (Phase 3)
Tickets	~100%	→	60%
Sponsorship	<20%	→	25%
Derivatives/IP	0%	→	15%

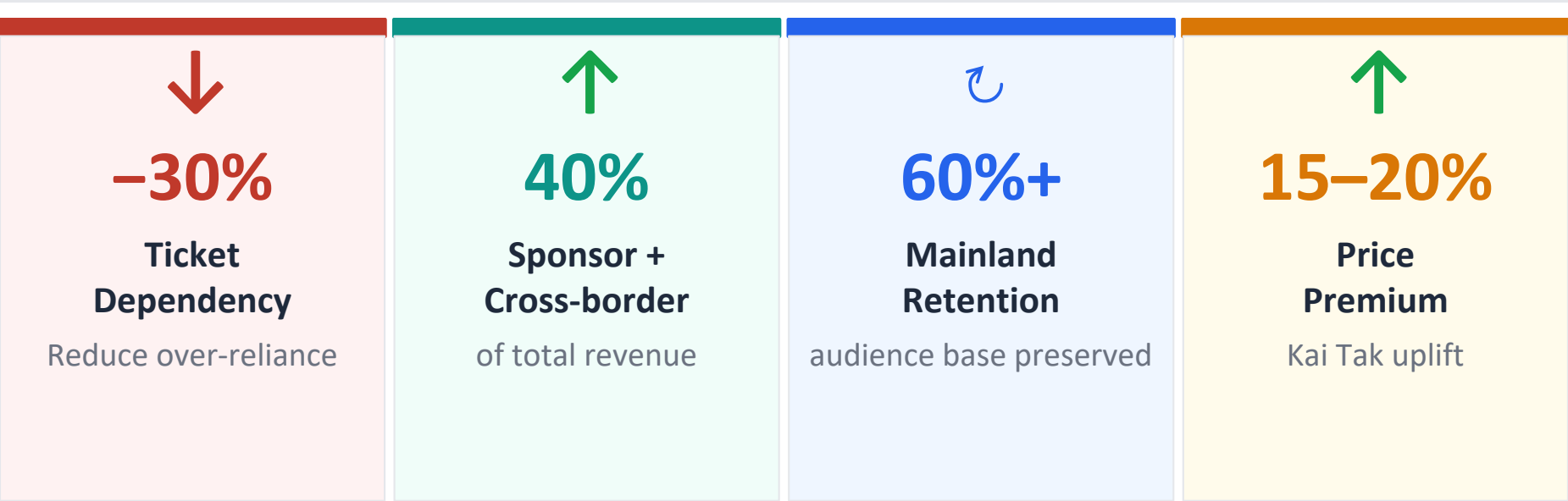
WHY THIS WORKS

- Kai Tak's 50,000 seats lifts ticket revenue in absolute terms even as share shrinks
- K-beauty, food & fashion brands unlock new sponsorship via KCON platform
- KR-CN co-produced IP generates royalties independent of live-event cycles

2 Dynamic Pricing Mechanism

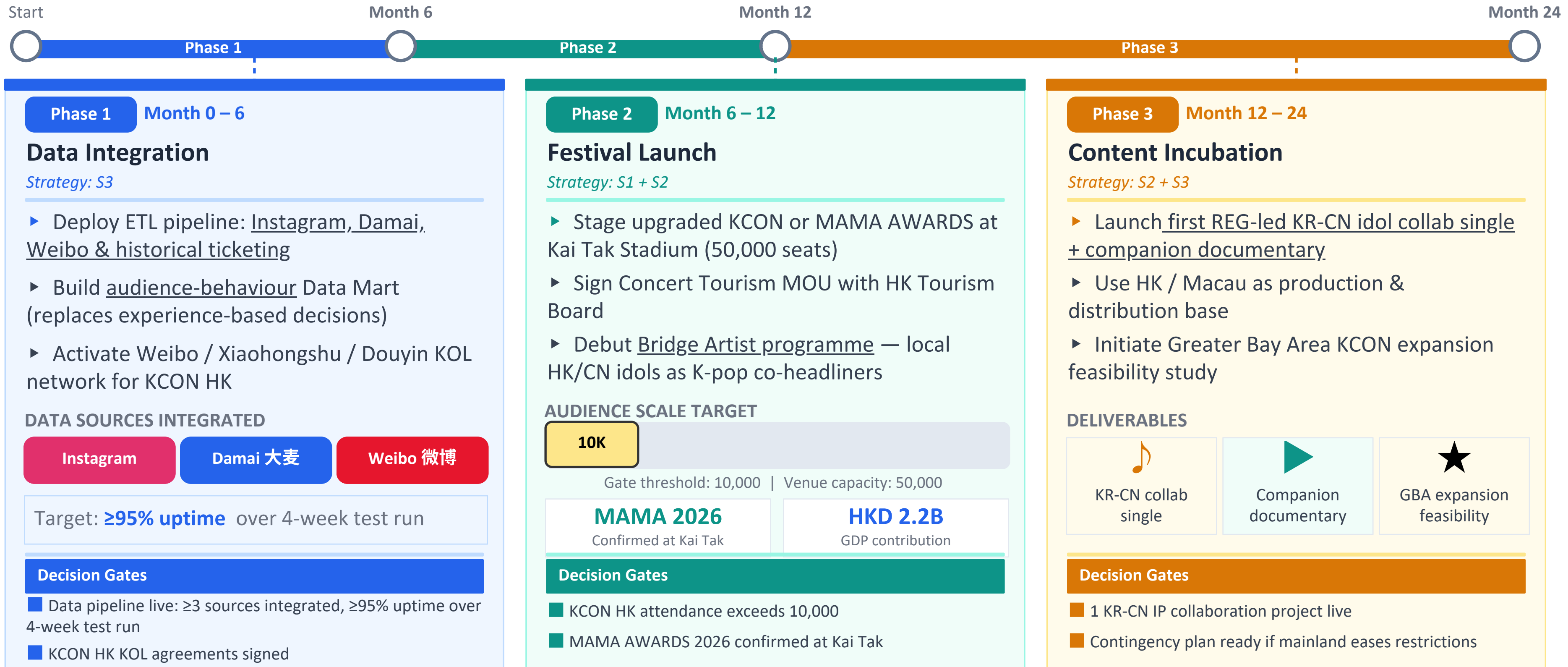


3 Key Financial Targets (2026–2028)



EXECUTION ROADMAP

Three phases, clear milestones, and go / no-go decision gates at each stage



RISK MATRIX & MITIGATION

Four structural risks REG faces — and why our strategy already addresses each one



RISK	SPECIFIC THREAT	SEV.	MITIGATION — HOW OUR STRATEGY RESPONDS
R1 Seven-Year Curse	K-pop groups disband or pause at contract expiry — or male idols enter military service. REG’s GOT7 concert was cancelled after COVID delays + disbandment, causing major losses.	HIGH	S3 Data lifecycle model flags group risk before committing — avoids blind bets S1 KCON multi-artist format spreads risk across 5–10 acts vs single-group tours
R2 Mainland Market Opens	If Mainland China lifts K-pop restrictions , 60–70% of REG’s HK audience has no reason to travel to HK. Fans go direct to Beijing & Shanghai — ticket revenue base collapses.	HIGH	S2 KR-CN IP co-creation means REG earns royalties even when fans stay in Mainland China S1 HK “First-Performance City” brand locks in Asia premieres — Mainland China only gets follow-up dates
R3 Competitor Price War	iMe (Chinese capital) continuously raises artist guarantees to outbid REG. Live Nation locks down JYP artists globally. REG risks being priced out of top-tier acts.	MED	S1 MAMA AWARDS + KCON IP gives artists a cultural reason to choose REG — beyond the fee S3 Data intelligence enables precise artist selection — we bet smart, not big
R4 Data Compliance	Cross-border data transfers (Weibo, Damai, Mainland China fans) may <u>violate</u> Mainland China or HK data sovereignty regulations — potentially shutting down REG's entire S3 data strategy.	MED	S3 Compliance checkpoints embedded in ETL pipeline from Day 1 — built-in, not retrofitted S3 Data onshore principle: Mainland China user data stays on Mainland China servers (Damai / Weibo). Only anonymised, aggregated insights are transmitted to REG HK — eliminating cross-border personal data risk
Roadmap → When & how to execute Financials → Where the revenue comes from Risk Matrix → We’ve anticipated the worst and planned			

APPENDIX— Financial Projection (HKD mn)

5-year revenue, cost and operating profit forecast | Scenario: Base case under proposed strategic transformation

Metric / Year (HKD mn)	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
A. REVENUE					
Ticketing Revenue	287	403	810	912	984
Sponsorship Revenue	90	155	338	380	410
Licensing / IP Revenue	33	62	203	228	246
Total Revenue (A)	410	620	1,350	1,520	1,640
B. COST (cash operating basis)					
Talent / Artist Guarantee & Production	190	253	535	579	606
Venue / Stage & Production	70	108	238	250	261
Marketing / PR & Channels	40	59	119	132	138
Ticketing / Distribution Fees	15	22	42	46	49
Ops / Security / Insurance / Permits	15	24	48	53	54
Data & Compliance Run-rate	8	16	30	30	31
IP Co-production (part may be capitalised)	15	57	176	226	271
Total Cost (B)	353	539	1,188	1,316	1,410
C. OPERATING BENEFIT					
Operating Profit (A – B)	57	81	162	204	230
Operating Margin (C / A)	13.9%	13.1%	12.0%	13.4%	14.0%

Notes: All figures in HKD million, linking audience scale (7k→15k→50k) to ticket, sponsorship, and IP shares defined in the strategy (Phase 3: 60%/25%/15%), with a ticket-price uplift (15–20%) applied to reflect the venue upgrade; costs are derived from standard event expense.All figures are produced as Low/Base/High scenarios by varying the key uncertain inputs